

MEHRAN AGHABOZORGI

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Generative Modeling: efficient generation, sample efficiency, multimodal generation

Reinforcement Learning: world models, model-based RL, offline RL, sample-efficient continuous control

Multimodal & Robot Learning: vision-language-action (VLA) policies, RL for VLAs, efficient inference for large multimodal / transformer models

EDUCATION

Simon Fraser University

Vancouver, Canada

Ph.D. in Computer Science — APEX Lab (Advisor: Ke Li); expected Fall 2026

2021 – present

- Affiliated with the Alberta Machine Intelligence Institute (Amii).

Isfahan University of Technology

Isfahan, Iran

B.Sc. in Computer Engineering — GPA 18.29/20 (ranked 1st)

2015 – 2020

EXPERIENCE

Research Intern

Jan 2026 – Sep 2026

RBC Borealis

Vancouver, Canada

- Accelerated Vision-Language-Action (VLA) policies whose inference cost limits real-time robotic control.
- Developed attention-guided token pruning and compressed-sensing token compression to cut latency and compute while preserving task success.

Research Intern

Aug – Oct 2019

Max Planck Institute for Informatics

Saarbrücken, Germany

- Enhanced the preprocessing phase of the SPASS SAT solver with Prof. Christoph Weidenbach; demonstrated improvements on competition-grade benchmarks.

Senior Developer

2017 – 2020

Morvarid

- Shipped production systems in Python, Java, Scala, and JavaScript: an anonymous, verifiable voting system and a security-focused cloud for end-to-end encrypted file storage.
- Led engineering for Ergo Pool (mining backends and payout automation) on the Ergo blockchain.

PAPERS

Dynamic Episode ALignment: Sample-Efficient Reinforcement Learning of Vision-Language-Action Models

2027

Mehran Aghabozorgi, Kian Hosseinkhani, Haowen Yao, Luis Figueredo, Ke Li

Under review at International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)

PAIR: Distance-Preserving Compression for Fast Inference and Adaptation of Vision-Language-Action Policies

2027

Mehran Aghabozorgi*, Kian Hosseinkhani*, Kry Yik Chau Lui, Kaito Suzuki, Ken Jiankun Zheng, Andy Zhang, Dantong Niu, Trevor Darrell, Roei Herzig, Ke Li (*equal contribution)

Under review at IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)

IMLE-LLM: Latent-Conditioned Windowed Decoding for Faster Inference

2027

Alireza Moazeni, Mehran Aghabozorgi, Tristan Engst, Ke Li

Under review at International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)

WIMLE: Uncertainty-Aware World Models with IMLE for Sample-Efficient Continuous Control

2026

Mehran Aghabozorgi, Yanshu Zhang, Alireza Moazeni, Ke Li

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) [project page]

IMLE-VLA: Fast Single-Step Action Generation for Vision-Language-Action Policies	2026
Kian Hosseinkhani, Qinhe Peng, George Shramko, Mehran Aghabozorgi , Jianing Qian, Tristan Engst, Alireza Moazeni, Dinesh Jayaraman, Ke Li	
<i>IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)</i> [project page]	
P-CORE: Self-Supervised Surface Consistency for Point-Based Neural Editing	2026
Yanshu Zhang, Shichong Peng, Mehran Aghabozorgi , Alireza Moazeni, Ke Li	
<i>European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV)</i> [project page]	
Adaptive IMLE for Few-shot Pretraining-free Generative Modelling	2023
Mehran Aghabozorgi , Shichong Peng, Ke Li	
<i>International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)</i> [project page]	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, C++, Scala, Java, JavaScript

ML & Deep Learning: PyTorch, JAX, distributed training (DDP, FSDP)

RL & Simulation: MuJoCo, DeepMind Control, MyoSuite

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- Helmut & Hugo Eppich Family Graduate Scholarship, Simon Fraser University (2026).
- Ph.D. Research Scholarship, Simon Fraser University — multiple terms (2024–2025).
- Graduate Fellowship, Simon Fraser University — multiple terms (2021–2024).
- ACM-ICPC West Asia Regional — **8th** (40th, Team TRIO) and **9th** (41st, Team Valar Geekolous).
- Ranked **2nd**, nationwide ICPC competition 2017 (Team Valar Geekolous).
- Nationwide AI Challenge (UIAI) — ranked **1st** (2018) and **2nd** (2017).